THE UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA

CONFINED DIFFUSION OF NANOPARTICLES USING iSCAT MICROSCOPY

by

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Abstract

Particle confinement allows extended measurements of suspended biomolecules and nanoparticles using optical microscopy as it keeps it within the field of view.

However, during confinement, the size-diffusivity relationship changes from that in bulk, where the correction factor is typically assumed without consideration of the occurring measurement conditions such as surface charges and the media.

In this work, we show that by combining interferometric scattering (iSCAT) microscopy with microfluidic nanoparticle confinement we can directly measure the positional distribution and depth-dependent diffusivity. We demonstrate how it depends on particle charge and media properties for both reference beads and lipid nanoparticles. Utilizing range-of-depth motion and in-plane diffusivity as complementary diameter estimates, we showcase how 3D particle tracking under confinement allows for nanoparticle diameter quantification in protein-containing media.

The ability to measure the effect of confined diffusivity improves accuracy in trajectory-based particle sizing in varying media, commonly found in cell biology and nanoparticle sizing.[2].

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Chapter 1

Introduction

1.1 Movivation

- What is the major field i am in? - what are the biological questions - how are they typically slved

- problems with the current solutions

In much of nature, the idea of size scales is widely discussed and investigated. From a basic understanding of physics, one understands that the forces an object feels are directly linked to their mass, or volume and mass density. For example, we can easily understand what will happen to a basketball if we throw it up into the air, as we are sitting on planet earth. However, when we leave the familar size scale, such as having a basketball the size of planet earth, or the size of a gas molecule, our intuition begins to show its cracks.

In size regime of nanoparticles, that is between 20-100nm, many biological particles of utmost importance tend to reside. For instance, in cellular biology, proteins, vesicles, enzymes, and organelles fit between 4 nm to 10 µm. In this size regime, the forces which one feels largely differ from that of say a basketball. Inter-molecular forces between nearby molecules have a strong effect on particle postion, thermal kicks from atomic molecules induce a stochastic motion non-determininstically, and forces of hydrodynamic pressure induce frictions slowing the particle down. Thus, to have any quantitative understnandig we must try to

1.2 Outline for Thesis

- Chapter 1 is an introduction/background - Chpater 2 discusses application of Widefield iSCAT for SPT in the Rayleigh Regime - Conclusion

Chapter 2

SPT in confinement principles

Biology is mostly nanoparticles. Nanoparticles move around stochastically under the rules of brownian motion. To be able to measure the particle's characteristics, one can relate their motion and stochasticity to their properties. This chapter will discuss the phenomena of Brownian motion and how it relates to particle properties, environmental ion concentration, viscosity, hydrodynamic boundaries, and confinement. To directly measure particle position, one can use optical methods, specifically, optical scattering measurements. In this chapter, the theoretical background regarding the particle's stochastic motion is presented, with particular focus on how the processes evolve in confined geometries. There will be a discussion on relating optical signals to their motion, as well as optical methods for particle detection.

Methods that are able to detect single nanoparticles are known as single-molecule measurements. In the field of optical microscopy, single-molecule methods are often referred to as single particle tracking (SPT). This chapter aims to direct the reader through the theoretical context of the work done. First, Brownian motion is discussed, then optical preliminaries for SPT, and lastly, biological motivation is touched upon to continue the introductory words.

2.1 Brownian Motion

The physical phenomenon of diffusion can be rigorously described as the emergent behavior atomic particle undergoing random collisions with members of the surrounding environment. In the microscopic limit, where the radius of a particle is sufficiently small and thermal fluctuations dominate its dynamics, this erratic motion is referred to as Brownian motion [1].

2.1.1 Classical Description of Einstein's Brownian Motion

The classical description of Brownian motion is concerned with how the molecuar-kinetic theory of heat reates with microscopically visible size suspensions in liquid perform movements such

that they can be viewed by a microscope.

2.1.2 Langevin Dynamics

- Brownian motion can alternatively be described using a Langevin Model. - introduce langevin equation - velocity correlation - Arrive at the Fluc-Dissipation - relate it to Einstein's formulation and show that given a stokes drag (sphere)

$$D = \frac{k_b T}{\gamma_0} \tag{2.1}$$

2.1.3 Smoluchowski Equation

- Since Langevin is kind of convient, how do we acctualy link the two methods?

- Fokker plank introdution motivated from the master equation - - ideally summarize van kampen.

- arrive at the general Smoluchowski equation for a random walker - simple plots for descriptive purposes.

2.2 Confined Diffusion Processes

Although diffusion is interesting, there is a wealth of complexity in confinement due to Hydrodynamic effects - quote 111 years here

- outline of this seciton

2.2.1 Hydrodynamic Confinement

- confinemnt from Hydrodynamics - frictional slowing - ...

2.2.2 Geometric Confinement

- i need to check references on if this is relate

2.2.3 Electrostatic Potentials

2.2.4 Example: Polystyrene Bead

2.3 Interferometric Scattering Principles

This section is devoted to the description of physical prinicples associated with light scattering techniques. These techniques are widely used in microscopy, as I have used them in measuring

where my parteicles are. Scattering measurements are of interest as they allow for label-free imaging with a high signal to noise and high temporal resolution.

We begin with the basics of relating light to electromagnetsm, starting with the Maxwell and Helmholtz relations. We continue discussing the scattering of a various size range of spheres, which is the approximation we take in this thesis. We then discuss the various abberations and Considerations before introducting iSCAT microscopy. We tease the experimental apparatus used in tthis work and compare the method to other methods currently used in the field.

2.3.1 Maxwell's Equations and field propagations equations

The photon is the fundamental quanta of the electric field as stated in QFT (cite). It has been shown that because of this, the field equations of light obey the fundamental principle that states

$$I = |\vec{E}(\vec{x}, t)|^2 \tag{2.2}$$

. Thus, it is paramount that we understand how the propagation of the electric fields are described. Luckily for us, this has already been solved in the year 18XX (cite). We present the Maxwell equations in their macroscopic form, which include terms from the material constants.

Definition 1. *Maxwell's Equations in macroscopic form. Let $\vec{x}$ be the position vecotr, t the time scalar. The Maxwell equations are defined as the following set of relations; (CITE ZANGWILL, Scattering small particles, Jackson if needed).*

$$\nabla \cdot \vec{D}(\vec{x}, t) = \rho_f(\vec{x}, t) \tag{2.3}$$

$$\nabla \times \vec{E}(\vec{x}, t) + \frac{\partial \vec{B}(\vec{x}, t)}{\partial t} = 0 \tag{2.4}$$

$$\nabla \cdot \vec{B}(\vec{x}, t) = 0 \tag{2.5}$$

$$\nabla \times \vec{H}(\vec{x}, t) - \frac{\partial \vec{D}(\vec{x}, t)}{\partial t} = \vec{J}_f(\vec{x}, t) \tag{2.6}$$

In addition, for ease of access, the definitions for the Auxillary fields, and scalar potentials are written. We also add the guage invariance;

$$\vec{D}(\vec{x}, t) = \varepsilon_0 \vec{E}(\vec{x}, t) + \vec{P}(\vec{x}, t) \tag{2.7}$$

$$\vec{H}(\vec{x}, t) = \frac{1}{\mu_0} \vec{B}(\vec{x}, t) - \vec{M}(\vec{x}, t) \tag{2.8}$$

To fully describe the material that the field lies in, we also require constitutive relations;

$$\vec{J}_f(\vec{x},t) = \sigma\vec{E}(\vec{x},t) \tag{2.9}$$
$$\vec{B}(\vec{x},t) = \mu\vec{H}(\vec{x},t) \tag{2.10}$$
$$\vec{P}(\vec{x},t) = \varepsilon_0\chi\vec{E}(\vec{x},t) \tag{2.11}$$
$$\tag{2.12}$$

Where the boldface is reserved for tensor quantities.

- List shit that we need to know before calcualting the Scattering from a sphere.

- Helmholtz Equation - Fresnel Equations - Polarization - General Scattering Transfer Matrices

2.3.2 The Mie and RDG Scattering off of a Sphere

- Set the stage, what do we need to solve, how are we going to do it - Solutions to the wave equation in spherical coordinates - Mie Theory – Examples of Mie spheres – What size range ? - RDG Theory – What size range ?

- Small comparison from far away, medium (mie), and small (RDG), atomic (too small)

2.3.3 Forward, Side, and Backscattering Models

- Olsén's thesis

2.3.4 Interferometric Light Scattering (iSCAT)

- Experimental Setup

2.3.5 Comparison of Methods

2.4 In-Vivo Considerations

- Now that we more or less know how BM works, why is it important in cells?

2.4.1 why does this matter for biological applications

2.4.2 Examples of Brownian Motion in Biology

2.5 Brownian motion as a method for measurements of size in biology

2.5.1 survey of methods using in this field

- Optical Methods - Bulk: DLS, - Single Molecule: SPT, NTA, FCS,

2.5.2 how confinemen effects these measurements

- Literature on why these methods are lacking

2.5.3 Probing of surface interactions with these methods

Chapter 3

Widefield backscattering iscat for SPT in 3d confinement tracking and analysis

3.1 Questions

3.2 Rayleigh scattering of nanoparticles

3.2.1 Parameterization used in this thesis

3.3 Methods

3.3.1 Optical System

3.3.2 Convex-lens induced confinement

3.4 Results i guess

3.5 Discussion of Results

Chapter 4

Conclusion

4.1 Conclusion

4.2 Future outlook

Bibliography

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